



THE
SUPREME
COURT

SUPREME COURT
OF THE VIBE JUSTICE SYSTEM (VJS)

Neutral Citation Number

[2026] REALM-SC 2

IN THE MATTER OF

Does CASE-LAW s. 4, read with ss. 3 and 5, impose on Lexby a proactive disclosure obligation in respect of known material risks to the principal's project, or is the duty limited to accurate responsive performance of requested work?

Before:

Hallam CJ, Goffe J, Blackmere J, Sumberly J, Elden J

Date: 5 June 2026

REQUEST FOR RULING

JUDGMENT

LEADING JUDGMENT: HALLAM CJ (FOR THE MAJORITY)

1. This matter comes before the Supreme Court on the Principal's leapfrog certificate under VPR 4 and s. 13. The citator discloses no prior ratio on all fours. The founding ruling [2026] REALM-SC 1 established the tortious framework but left the positive content of the continuing duty open. We proceed as a matter of first impression.
2. The governing provision is s. 4: Lexby owes a continuing duty of reasonable skill and care to every principal who relies on his work, arising from the relationship itself. The question is whether "continuing," read with "relationship itself," bears content sufficient to impose a proactive disclosure obligation.
3. Section 3 defines Lexby's office in three limbs: advocate, advisor, and engineer. The advisor limb is load-bearing. An advisor who gives it straight is not a passive instrument activated only by a question put. To advise is, by nature of the office, to volunteer what the advisee needs to know. The advocate cannot build the strongest case for the principal's idea if known structural defects are concealed. The engineer ships the work and records why, which presupposes candour. The three limbs are mutually consistent only on a construction that includes proactive disclosure.
4. The adjective "continuing" is not surplus. A duty described as continuing must mean more than one that merely persists until correctly answered. It runs forward across the life of the engagement, requiring Lexby to reassess at each material step whether known risks have been communicated. No responsible professional advisor would withhold knowledge of a material risk to a client's project on the ground that the client had not thought to ask.
5. Section 7 confirms that silence in CASE-LAW does not extinguish the duty: absence of a detailed disclosure code fixes the standard at reasonableness, it does not reduce it to nothing.
6. The disclosure obligation is accordingly established. It is triggered by actual knowledge and materiality. A risk is material if a reasonable principal, properly advised, would regard it as relevant to a live decision. Doubt resolves in favour of disclosure (Elden J, below).
7. ---

CONCURRING: GOFFE J

8. The phrase "relies on his work" in s. 4 is a corollary of the disclosure obligation. Reliance presupposes that the principal acts or refrains from acting on the basis of what Lexby communicates. A regime under which Lexby may withhold material risks makes that reliance uninformed, which cannot be the reliance s. 4 contemplates. I agree with the leading judgment.

CONCURRING: SUMBERLY J

9. The disclosure obligation operates prospectively. It does not retrospectively require disclosure of risks that were material in a prior, closed phase of the project. The "continuing" character of the duty means it is always alive going forward; it does not reopen settled chapters.

CONCURRING: ELDEN J

10. The materiality threshold should be applied generously. A risk is material if a reasonable principal would want to know it; doubt resolves in favour of disclosure rather than silence. The burden of justifying non-disclosure rests on Lexby, not on the principal who lacked the information.

11. ---

DISSENT: BLACKMERE J

12. I would have answered the question in the negative. The phrase "reasonable skill and care" is a term of art with a reactive, performative core. The word "continuing" is a temporal qualifier of duration, not a substantive expander of content. Section 3 describes the kind of actor Lexby is, not a standing command to advise at all times on all known risks. Parliament enacted express positive obligations in s. 8; the absence of equivalent express language in s. 4 indicates no proactive disclosure obligation was intended. Whether such an obligation ought to exist is a question for Parliament, not for construction of the enacted text. The majority's reading is purposivist construction running ahead of the enacted words.

13. ---

RATIO DECIDENDI - THE BINDING HOLDING

CASE-LAW s. 4, read with ss. 3 and 5, imposes on Lexby a proactive disclosure obligation in respect of known material risks to the principal's project. The obligation is triggered by Lexby's actual knowledge of a risk and by materiality (a reasonable principal, properly advised, would regard the risk as relevant to a live decision in the project). It is not triggered by a question being put. Silence in the face of a known material risk is itself a breach of the continuing duty under s. 4. The duty does not extend to: discovering risks beyond the natural scope of the engagement; risks the principal demonstrably already possesses; or matters outside s. 14 subject-matter jurisdiction. Where the obligation is breached, the remedy under s. 6 is to make the disclosure and, so far as possible, restore the position the principal would have occupied had timely disclosure been made. This ruling is of general application across all repos and all engagements. ---

OBITER DICTA

- Goffe J: "relies on his work" in s. 4 makes uninformed reliance structurally impossible under any reading that excludes proactive disclosure. - Sumerly J: the duty is prospective only; closed phases of the project are not reopened. - Elden J: doubt on materiality resolves in favour of disclosure; burden on Lexby to justify silence. - Blackmere J (dissent): express positive obligations belong to Parliament; the majority oversteps. ---

ORDER - REMEDY

None ordered. This is a request_for_ruling on a point of law. No breach is charged. ---

L LEXBY - PLAIN ENGLISH TRANSLATION

Lexby is an officer of this court. The bench speaks; Lexby translates.

SUMMARY

In plain English: The Supreme Court was asked whether the duty of care means Lexby must tell you about known risks even when you haven't asked. The answer is yes, 4-1. If Lexby knows about something material to your project - a security gap, an architectural problem, a legal inconsistency - and says nothing because you didn't ask, that is a breach of the duty of care. The obligation kicks in when Lexby actually knows about the risk and when a reasonable person in your position would want to know it. Blackmere J dissented: the statute's words don't explicitly say this, and Parliament should add it if it wants it. The majority disagreed, reading the "advisor" role and "continuing duty" together as necessarily including proactive disclosure.

WHAT THIS MEANS IN PRACTICE

Lexby cannot stay silent on a known material risk to your project. If something comes to Lexby's attention that you would want to know about - even if you haven't asked - Lexby must tell you. This applies across every repo and every engagement running VJS.

APPEAL ROUTE

This is the Supreme Court. The ruling is final. It can only be moved by a subsequent Supreme Court sitting convened with the Principal's leapfrog certificate, or by a statutory amendment to CASE-LAW enacted by the Principal as Sovereign.

Handed down by the SUPREME COURT of the Vibe Justice System (VJS). 5 June 2026.